

TRT GUY

THE TRT 101 GUIDE

HOW TO GET THE MOST OUT OF TESTOSTERONE REPLACEMENT THERAPY

By @trt_guy

This guide will help you get the most out of your TRT by covering the treatment considerations, lifestyle habits, training principles, nutrition fundamentals, and supplements that can help you get the most out of testosterone replacement therapy.

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

This guide is for educational purposes only. It is not medical advice and should not replace care from a qualified healthcare professional.

Do not begin, stop, or modify testosterone, HCG, aromatase inhibitors, or any other medication without discussing it with your prescribing clinician.

TRT can also suppress sperm production. If you currently want children—or may want them in the future—discuss fertility preservation with a knowledgeable physician before starting or changing treatment.

01 TRT IS NOT MAGIC

TRT is not a magic pill—or a magic injection.

The purpose of legitimate testosterone replacement therapy is to restore testosterone to a healthy physiological range and alleviate symptoms associated with clinically low testosterone.

Depending on the individual, this may improve:

- Energy
- Libido
- Mood
- Motivation
- Recovery
- Strength
- Muscle retention
- Overall quality of life

However, TRT does not automatically make you lean, muscular, healthy, disciplined, or successful.

It may give you more energy, motivation, and capacity to do the work—but you still have to show up every day and use those tools properly.

Testosterone cannot outwork a poor diet, inactivity, excessive alcohol consumption, bad sleep, uncontrolled stress, or an improperly designed training program.

**TRT IS ONE PART OF THE EQUATION.
WHAT YOU DO WITH IT IS WHAT ULTIMATELY MATTERS.**

02 MAKE SURE YOUR TREATMENT MAKES SENSE

Before we dive into lifestyle habits, we need to make sure your treatment is actually well designed.

Your TRT protocol should be based on:

- Your symptoms
- Your bloodwork
- Your response to treatment
- Your health history
- Your fertility goals
- Your preferences
- Negative effects you experience

There is no single perfect protocol for every man.

However, if your treatment leaves you feeling terrible, creates constant side effects, or requires another medication every time a problem appears, it may be time to reevaluate the protocol or get a second opinion.

CONFIRM THAT TRT WAS ACTUALLY NECESSARY

A proper diagnosis should generally include symptoms consistent with testosterone deficiency and repeatedly low testosterone levels measured under appropriate conditions.

TRT should not be prescribed solely because someone wants more muscle, better gym performance, or a higher number on a laboratory report.

The goal is not to chase the highest testosterone level possible.

The goal is to resolve symptoms while maintaining healthy, stable, and well-tolerated hormone levels.

03 CHOOSE THE RIGHT DELIVERY METHOD

In my opinion, testosterone cypionate and testosterone enanthate are the best options for TRT.

TESTOSTERONE GELS

Testosterone gels have a risk of transference.

If you have a wife or children, testosterone can be transferred to them through contact with an unwashed or uncovered application site. That is not something I would want to risk happening to my family.

Yes, you can reduce the risk by washing your hands, covering the application site, and following the instructions perfectly—but I would rather avoid the problem altogether.

Gels can also be inconsistent. Absorption can vary from person to person, and it can be difficult to accurately control the amount of testosterone that enters your system.

If you need to modify your dose, it can be much more difficult to make precise adjustments with a gel than with an injection.

For those reasons, I do not recommend gels.

TESTOSTERONE PELLETS

I do not like pellets either. They are expensive, uncomfortable to have inserted, and extremely difficult to adjust.

Once the pellets are inside your body, you are committed to that dose until they gradually wear off. If the dose is too high, too low, or causes side effects, you cannot simply adjust it with your next injection.

TRT often requires some experimentation and dose adjustment to find what works best for you. Pellets make that process unnecessarily difficult.

LONG-ACTING TESTOSTERONE

I am also not a fan of long-acting testosterone products such as testosterone undecanoate, including products like Nebido.

They are marketed as convenient because you only need a few injections throughout the year.

The problem is that they are difficult to adjust, and some men begin experiencing returning low-testosterone symptoms before their next scheduled injection.

If the dose is wrong or you do not respond well, you cannot make quick, precise changes. You may have to wait weeks or months for the medication level to decline.

I would rather use a form of testosterone that gives me more control over the dose, injection frequency, and how quickly the protocol can be adjusted.

TESTOSTERONE CYPIONATE AND ENANTHATE

In my opinion, testosterone cypionate and testosterone enanthate are the best options.

They are effective, affordable, widely available, and easy to adjust.

If your dose needs to be increased or decreased, you can make a small and precise adjustment. You can also divide your weekly dose into smaller, more frequent injections to maintain more stable testosterone levels.

I recommend injecting a minimum of twice per week. Three injections per week can be even better, and some men prefer small daily injections.

More frequent injections can reduce the large peaks and troughs that may occur with bigger, less frequent doses.

THE OBJECTIVE IS SIMPLE:

Use the smallest effective dose, inject frequently enough to maintain stable levels, and choose a form of testosterone that allows you to make precise adjustments when needed.

For me, that means testosterone cypionate or testosterone enanthate.

04 CONSIDER YOUR INJECTION FREQUENCY

Large, infrequent injections can create larger peaks and troughs in testosterone levels.

You may feel great shortly after the injection and then experience lower energy, mood changes, or returning symptoms as you approach the next dose.

For testosterone cypionate or enanthate, I generally prefer a minimum of two injections per week. Depending on the individual, three weekly injections or smaller daily injections may create more stable levels.

Daily injections are not necessary for everyone.

The right frequency depends on your dose, response, bloodwork, convenience, and ability to remain consistent.

The main objective is to avoid unnecessary hormonal swings while keeping the protocol simple enough to follow.

| CONSISTENCY BEATS COMPLEXITY.

05 DO NOT AUTOMATICALLY BLAME ESTROGEN

Estradiol is not the enemy.

Men need sufficient estrogen for:

- Sexual function
- Bone health
- Mood
- Cardiovascular function
- Joint health
- Brain function

Some men are automatically prescribed an aromatase inhibitor when they begin TRT.

Others are prescribed one as soon as they experience bloating, mood changes, nipple sensitivity, or sexual problems.

However, those symptoms do not automatically prove that estrogen is the problem.

Before adding another medication, evaluate the entire protocol:

- Is the testosterone dose unnecessarily high?
- Are the injections too large or too infrequent?
- Was the blood test timed appropriately?

- Is excessive body fat contributing to greater aromatization?
- Could the symptoms have another cause?
- Is estradiol genuinely elevated and creating persistent problems?

It should not automatically be included in every TRT protocol, and you definitely should not need it with your long term treatment.

In many cases, decreasing your body fat levels, lowering the testosterone dose or changing the injection frequency may resolve the problem without requiring another medication.

The goal should be to use the simplest effective protocol—not to keep adding medications to correct problems created by the original protocol.

06 UNDERSTAND HCG AND FERTILITY

TRT suppresses the signals that normally tell your testicles to produce testosterone and sperm.

HCG can imitate one of those signals and may help maintain intratesticular testosterone, testicular size, and sperm production in some men.

Therefore, HCG may be useful if:

- You want to preserve fertility.
- You are actively trying to conceive.
- Maintaining testicular size or function is important to you.
- Your fertility specialist believes it is appropriate.

However, HCG is not automatically necessary for every man on TRT.

It adds another medication to the protocol and may create additional side effects or make estrogen management more complicated.

If you do not care about fertility or preserving testicular function, ask your clinician what HCG is expected to accomplish in your specific situation.

MORE MEDICATION DOES NOT AUTOMATICALLY MEAN BETTER TREATMENT.

If you are currently trying to conceive, do not assume that TRT plus HCG will guarantee fertility. Work with a qualified physician and monitor your fertility with semen analyses when appropriate.

07 MONITOR YOUR TREATMENT

TRT should not be a “take the injection and forget about it” treatment.

You should monitor your symptoms, side effects, blood pressure, and laboratory markers with your clinician.

Depending on your situation, monitoring may include:

- Total and free testosterone
- Complete blood count and hematocrit
- Estradiol when clinically relevant
- Blood pressure
- Lipids
- Blood glucose and A1C
- Liver and kidney markers
- PSA and prostate health when appropriate
- Fertility testing when relevant

Your bloodwork should be interpreted alongside how you feel—not in isolation.

A high testosterone number does not mean the treatment is working if you feel terrible or your health markers are deteriorating.

08 RULE NUMBER ONE: DON'T BE FAT

My first TRT lifestyle rule is blunt:

| DO NOT BE FAT.

If you are overweight, you need to be doing something about it.

Excess body fat can contribute to:

- Poor insulin sensitivity
- Chronic inflammation
- Higher blood pressure
- Sleep apnea
- Worse cardiovascular health
- Greater conversion of testosterone into estrogen
- Difficulty maintaining stable energy and appetite

TRT does not automatically make you lean.

If you struggle with excessive body fat, the first things we need to evaluate are your nutrition, daily activity, cardiovascular training, and resistance-training habits.

09 GET YOUR NUTRITION UNDER CONTROL

If your goal is to lose fat, there are three basic things you need to do.

1. CREATE A CALORIE DEFICIT

You must consistently consume fewer calories than your body uses.

TRT does not change this fundamental rule.

You can eat healthy foods and still fail to lose fat if you consistently consume too many calories.

2. EAT SUFFICIENT PROTEIN

Protein helps you maintain muscle while losing fat. It also supports recovery, controls hunger, and makes it easier to build or preserve a strong physique.

Build each major meal around a quality protein source.

3. TRACK YOUR CALORIC INTAKE

You do not necessarily have to track calories forever.

However, if you have no idea how much you are eating, tracking for a period of time can show you where your calories are coming from and why you may not be making progress.

Guessing usually does not work.

Awareness creates control.

4. EAT PLENTY OF FRUITS AND VEGETABLES

I recommend making fruits and vegetables a major part of your daily diet.

A personal target I often use is approximately two and a half to three and a half pounds of fruits and vegetables per day, depending on the person's size, digestion, appetite, and total caloric needs.

If you are currently eating very little produce, build toward that amount gradually.

Fruits and vegetables provide:

- Fiber
- Vitamins
- Minerals
- Antioxidants
- More food volume for fewer calories

This makes rule number one—getting lean and staying lean—much easier to follow.

When your diet contains plenty of protein, fruits, vegetables, legumes, whole grains, and other minimally processed foods, you naturally leave less room for foods that make it easy to overconsume calories.

10 DO CARDIOVASCULAR ACTIVITY

Your heart is a muscle, and TRT does not remove the need to train it.

You need to perform cardiovascular activity every week.

This can include:

- Brisk walking
- Running
- Cycling
- Swimming

- Rowing
- Hiking
- Martial arts
- Brazilian jiu-jitsu
- Any sport that keeps your heart rate elevated

I personally love combat sports, but it does not have to be a combat sport.

The general target is at least 150 minutes of moderate-intensity activity or 75 minutes of vigorous activity per week. You can also combine the two.

Choose something you enjoy enough to continue doing consistently.

11 WALK EVERY DAY

Walking is one of the most fundamental human activities.

There is almost no reason not to walk unless you have a medical or physical limitation.

Walking helps you:

- Increase daily caloric expenditure
- Improve cardiovascular health
- Control blood glucose
- Support digestion
- Manage stress
- Get leaner
- Stay lean after losing weight

You do not have to turn every walk into an intense workout.

Walk after meals. Walk while taking phone calls. Walk with your children. Park farther away. Take the stairs.

The objective is to build movement into your normal life.

12 LIFT WEIGHTS

One of the most important things you can do while on TRT is resistance training.

AT A MINIMUM, LIFT WEIGHTS TWICE PER WEEK.

You can build a strong, athletic, great-looking body with two well-designed sessions per week. You can train more frequently if you enjoy it and can recover properly, but many of my busiest clients get excellent results lifting two or three times per week.

The quality of the training matters more than adding unnecessary training days.

Focus on:

- Compound movements
- Good technique
- Full ranges of motion
- Gradually becoming stronger
- Training sufficiently close to muscular failure
- Recording your workouts
- Recovering between sessions

You do not need a complicated program.

You need a good program that you can execute consistently.

13 BE SENSIBLE WITH ALCOHOL

You are on TRT because you want to feel better, become healthier, and improve your quality of life.

Getting hammered every weekend—or drinking every night—is not going to help you accomplish that.

My recommendation is to avoid alcohol or limit it severely.

If you choose to drink, keep it occasional and controlled. For many of my clients, that means no more than one or two drinks per week.

Do not let alcohol sabotage your sleep, nutrition, training, blood pressure, or decision-making.

14 DO NOT SMOKE

You are trying to improve your health.

Smoking does the opposite.

If you smoke, quitting may be one of the most important health decisions you can make—regardless of how well optimized your testosterone protocol is.

15 SLEEP SEVEN TO NINE HOURS

Try to sleep seven to nine hours every night.

I understand that this can be difficult if you are the father of a toddler or dealing with circumstances outside your control.

However, make sure poor sleep is not happening because of choices you can control, such as:

- Doom-scrolling at night
- Watching Netflix for hours
- Consuming caffeine late in the day
- Using stimulants too close to bedtime

- Drinking alcohol at night
- Going to bed at inconsistent times
- Keeping your phone beside your bed

Create a consistent bedtime and wake-up time. Keep your room cool, dark, and quiet. Give yourself enough time in bed to obtain the sleep you need.

16 CONTROL YOUR STRESS

Chronic stress can damage both your physical and mental health.

It can affect your sleep, appetite, blood pressure, relationships, decision-making, and ability to remain consistent with your habits.

Meditation is one of the simplest tools you can use to manage stress.

You do not need to meditate for an hour.

Start with five to ten minutes per day and gradually build the habit.

Other useful stress-management tools include:

- Walking outside
- Breathing exercises
- Spending time with your family
- Journaling
- Reducing unnecessary commitments
- Limiting social media
- Spending time in nature
- Talking to a therapist when needed

Being on TRT does not make you immune to stress.

You still need a strategy for managing it.

17 SUPPLEMENTS: WHAT TO TAKE COMES AFTER WHAT TO DO

Supplements can be helpful, but they are not magic pills.

Before asking what you should take, look at what you need to do.

Swallowing pills will not compensate for:

- A poor diet
- Excessive body fat
- Inactivity
- Bad sleep
- Excessive alcohol
- Smoking
- Uncontrolled stress
- An inappropriate TRT protocol

Your lifestyle habits come first.

Once those habits are in place, supplements may help fill specific gaps based on your diet, bloodwork, health conditions, and goals.

OMEGA-3S

If your diet is low in EPA and DHA, a high-quality omega-3 supplement may be useful.

I often consider a combined EPA and DHA intake in the range of two to three grams per day, but that dose is not appropriate for everyone.

Discuss higher-dose omega-3 supplementation with your clinician—especially if you take blood-thinning medication, have a bleeding disorder, or have experienced heart-rhythm problems.

VITAMIN D

Vitamin D supplementation may be useful if your bloodwork shows that your level is low or your clinician believes your intake and sun exposure are insufficient.

Do not assume that more is always better.

Vitamin D is fat-soluble, and excessive supplementation can be harmful. Ideally, determine your dose using bloodwork.

MULTIVITAMIN

A high-quality multivitamin may help cover nutritional gaps, particularly when calories are restricted.

However, a multivitamin should be seen as an 'addition' to a good diet, not a replacement for one.

Look for a reputable, appropriately dosed, third-party-tested product. I like thorne essential minerals, or strom sports multi max.

VITAMIN B12

Vitamin B12 is especially important if you follow a vegan or predominantly plant-based diet.

You may use a dedicated B12 supplement or an appropriately formulated B-complex, depending on your diet and bloodwork.

CREATINE

Creatine monohydrate is one of the most useful and well-researched performance supplements available.

A simple daily dose of five grams is sufficient for most people.

You do not need to cycle it, and you do not need an expensive form of creatine.

MAGNESIUM

Magnesium may support relaxation and sleep when dietary intake is inadequate.

Some people prefer taking it in the evening or before bed.

The appropriate form and dose depend on your diet, digestion, medications, kidney function, and individual tolerance.

18 YOUR TRT 101 CHECKLIST

Use this list to evaluate where you currently stand.

YOUR TREATMENT

- ☐ I have a legitimate diagnosis and a qualified prescribing clinician.
- ☐ My testosterone dose is based on symptoms, bloodwork, and health markers.
- ☐ My delivery method works for my lifestyle.
- ☐ My injection schedule keeps me reasonably stable.
- ☐ I am not automatically treating every symptom with another medication.
- ☐ My fertility goals have been discussed.
- ☐ I monitor my bloodwork, blood pressure, symptoms, and side effects.

YOUR NUTRITION

- ☐ I understand approximately how many calories I consume.
- ☐ I am in a calorie deficit if I need to lose fat.
- ☐ I eat sufficient protein.
- ☐ I eat plenty of fruits and vegetables.
- ☐ Most of my food comes from minimally processed sources.

YOUR TRAINING

- ☐ I lift weights at least twice per week.
- ☐ I follow a structured program.
- ☐ I focus on good technique and progressive overload.
- ☐ I perform cardiovascular activity every week.
- ☐ I walk and remain active throughout the day.

YOUR LIFESTYLE

- ☐ I sleep seven to nine hours whenever possible.
- ☐ I avoid smoking.
- ☐ I avoid alcohol or keep it severely limited.
- ☐ I manage my stress.
- ☐ I do not allow social media, stimulants, or entertainment to destroy my sleep.

YOUR SUPPLEMENTS

- ☐ I use supplements to fill specific gaps.
- ☐ I do not expect supplements to replace healthy habits.
- ☐ I choose reputable, appropriately dosed products.
- ☐ I use bloodwork and professional guidance when appropriate.

FINAL THOUGHTS

TRT can be life-changing when it is medically appropriate, intelligently managed, and supported by the right lifestyle.

But testosterone does not do the work for you.

It will not automatically make you lean.

It will not automatically build an impressive physique.

It will not automatically fix your relationships, discipline, nutrition, sleep, or cardiovascular health.

TRT may give you more tools.

You still have to use them.

Dial in your treatment. Control your nutrition. Lift weights. Train your cardiovascular system. Walk every day. Sleep properly. Manage stress. Avoid destructive habits.

Do those things consistently, and you will be in a much better position to get everything you can from your treatment.

NEED HELP GETTING THE MOST OUT OF TRT?

Through my one-on-one coaching program, I help men dial in their nutrition, training, cardiovascular fitness, daily habits, and accountability so they can build a lean, strong, athletic body without sacrificing their health.

[**CLICK HERE TO LEARN MORE**](#)